

Parks Department Meeting July 15th 2025 Part #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tOa3-KpPOCE
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Target Category	muncie_city

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held prior to the regular meeting).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called to order the Muny Parks and Recreation Board meeting on Tuesday, July 15th [00:00:36](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Chandra Parks, Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall, Mark Irvin (arrived shortly after roll call).
 - **Members Absent:** James Lutton (excused due to personal issues).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as Board leadership/Chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board stood for the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:42](#) and held a moment of silence for an athlete who participated in and tragically passed away following the Iron Man triathlon over the weekend [00:01:10](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the June meeting and the executive session were presented, discussed, and approved by voice vote [00:03:00](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:03:32 Superintendent Report & Community Acknowledgments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Superintendent Malone introduced Ken Hudson, Director of the Whitley Community Council, to thank the neighborhood association for stepping up as a fiscal agent and partner to assist the summer program for 110 kids [00:03:38](#).
 - Introduced Misty Reigns as the new interim operations manager for Prairie Creek to assist during current medical leave in the office [00:06:56](#).
 - Provided operational updates regarding park cleanups following fallen trees/branches, mowing catch-ups, partnerships with Ron Baum (bass fishing tournament), the Ironman event, and safety updates at Tuhey Pool. Discussed ongoing restroom renovations at Thomas Park (estimated 2-4 weeks) and Riverview Park (out to bid), lighting and security issues at Heaton Park, and pricing for replacement park signage and wood/aluminum signs.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.

00:23:52 Programming Update & Event Approvals

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikki (Programming Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Outlined the final week of the summer youth program, upcoming culmination ceremony on Friday at North Side, youth basketball league games starting at McCullum Park, upcoming Black Expo youth basketball tournament at Heaton Park (signups July 31, games Aug 1-2), and the backpack giveaway partnership with Walmart South on July 22.
 - Outlined fall programming including Trunk or Treat on October 18 (scheduled early to avoid conflict with Ball State Homecoming) and a tentative winter coat drive on November 4.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - **Union Missionary Baptist Church Event Approval ([00:27:18](#)):** Requesting McCullum Park on August 16 from 12:00 PM to 4:00 PM for an annual community picnic expecting ~300 people, with security provided by Legacy Life Security Solutions. Requested waiver of rental fees for equipment (bleachers, tents, stage). Board discussion noted policy against waiving fees, agreeing to waive fees only for stationary bleachers already on site, while maintaining fees for tents and stages. **Approved by Voice Vote [00:30:57](#).**

- **Washington Group Event Approval (00:31:10):** Follow-up approval for the Washington group's upcoming August event following successful execution and positive foot traffic from prior events. **Approved by Voice Vote 00:32:16.**

00:32:41 Prairie Creek Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Klaw (Prairie Creek Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Provided brief updates on staffing adjustments, medical and FMLA leaves, and assistance from the mayor's team on recent park projects. *(Note: Transcript cuts off during this report).*
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: No open public comment period or distinct citizen forum occurred during this portion of the transcript, as presentations were handled directly by invited community partners like Ken Hudson during staff reports).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Mention of ongoing maintenance tasks, upcoming athletic tournaments, and event schedules.
- **Adjournment:** The transcript concludes during the Prairie Creek departmental report without a formal spoken adjournment timestamp or recorded motion to adjourn.

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